# Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy

BluePeak Technologies | Vacation and personal time

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| Owner | People Operations | Approved by | Executive Leadership Team |
| Classification | Internal | Category | Leave and Attendance |
| Audience | All employees | Status | Approved |
| Supersedes | BPT-HR-PTO-001 v1.0; BPT-HR-PTO-001 v2.0 policy update | Source | https://employee.bluepeaktech.com/resources/hr/leave/paid-time-off |

Document purpose. The current consolidated rules for PTO eligibility, accrual, use, scheduling, carryover, maximum balance, leave coordination, and separation payout.

# Contents

# Quick Answers

| Question | Current rule |
|---|---|
| How much PTO do I receive? | Full-time employees receive 15, 18, 20, or 23 days per year based on completed service. |
| When can a new hire use PTO? | Accrued PTO may be used after 30 calendar days of employment. |
| How far ahead should I request it? | At least 5 business days; at least 10 business days for 3 or more consecutive workdays. |
| How much carries over? | Up to 10 unused days carry into the next calendar year. |
| When does excess carryover expire? | Carried time above the normal annual bank must be used by March 31. |
| What is the maximum balance? | 25 days. Accrual pauses at the cap and resumes after the balance drops below it. |
| Can I buy or sell PTO? | No. BluePeak does not offer a PTO purchase or sale program. |
| Is unused PTO paid at separation? | Accrued unused PTO is paid at base rate in the final paycheck, subject to applicable law and valid deductions. |

> Key rule: This v3.0 document is the current complete policy. It incorporates the carryover changes that became effective July 1, 2026 and supersedes the earlier full policy and separate update notice.

# 1. Purpose and Scope

PTO provides paid time away for vacation, personal matters, rest, and other planned needs that are not covered by a more specific leave. The policy applies to regular U.S. employees scheduled at least 20 hours per week. Dublin employees receive annual leave under local terms and law; where this company schedule is more generous and legally compatible, People Operations will explain the applicable benefit.

PTO is separate from company holidays, Sick Leave, Parental Leave, Bereavement Leave, jury or military leave, disability benefits, and other statutory leave. Employees should use the leave type that most accurately describes the absence.

# 2. Eligibility

## 2.1 Full-Time Employees

Regular employees scheduled 30 or more hours per week accrue the full-time amount. Temporary employees, interns, contractors, and agency workers are not eligible unless written program terms state otherwise.

## 2.2 Part-Time Employees

Regular employees scheduled 20 to 29 hours per week accrue a prorated amount based on scheduled weekly hours divided by 40. For example, an employee scheduled 20 hours per week receives 50 percent of the applicable full-time allowance, or 7.5 days in the 0-2 year band. The HR system converts the amount to hours using the employee's standard day.

## 2.3 Changes in Schedule or Status

A change between full-time and part-time status changes future accrual beginning with the first full payroll period after the effective date. Previously accrued PTO remains in the bank, subject to the 25-day maximum. A transfer between eligible U.S. roles does not restart service for the tenure band.

# 3. Annual Allowance and Accrual

| Completed service | Monthly full-time accrual | Annual full-time total | Maximum bank |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0 through 2 years | 1.25 days | 15 days | 25 days |
| 3 through 5 years | 1.50 days | 18 days | 25 days |
| 6 through 9 years | 1.667 days | 20 days | 25 days |
| 10 or more years | 1.917 days | 23 days | 25 days |

PTO accrues monthly and is credited after the employee completes the applicable month of eligible service. Employees who start or change eligibility during a month receive a prorated credit. Service-band increases begin in the month after the anniversary that completes the required service.

PTO accrues during active work and fully paid company leave, including paid parental leave. PTO normally does not accrue during an unpaid leave or after short-term disability pay begins, unless law or written terms require otherwise.

## 3.1 Accrual Corrections

Employees should review the balance shown in the Employee Portal. Report a suspected error to people@bluepeaktech.com within 30 days of discovery. People Operations will verify service, schedule, leave status, prior use, and system transactions. A correction may increase or decrease the balance and will be documented.

# 4. Using PTO

## 4.1 Waiting Period

A new employee may use accrued PTO after 30 calendar days of employment. A manager and People Operations may approve an advance of up to 5 days for a significant pre-existing commitment or emergency. An advance creates a negative balance that is recovered through future accrual or, where lawful and authorized, final pay.

## 4.2 Request Timing

1 Submit a request at least 5 business days before the first day of planned PTO.

1 Submit a request for 3 or more consecutive workdays at least 10 business days in advance.

1 Longer, seasonal, or high-demand absences should be discussed as early as possible.

1 An emergency or unexpected need may be submitted as soon as practicable; the normal notice period does not prevent an employee from requesting time.

Requests are submitted through the Employee Portal or Leave Request Form. Employees should not make nonrefundable commitments until approval is recorded.

## 4.3 Approval Standards

Managers consider customer and operational coverage, overlapping requests, deadlines, fairness, prior commitments, and the employee's available balance. Managers should respond within 3 business days when practical. A manager may propose alternate dates but should not deny PTO for an arbitrary, retaliatory, or discriminatory reason.

When competing requests cannot all be approved, managers should use a transparent method such as timing of request, rotating priority, critical role coverage, or prior approved commitments. Seniority alone is not the default.

### 4.4 Increments and Partial Days

Non-exempt employees record PTO in increments of 1 hour. Exempt employees normally record half-day or full-day absences, although the HR system may display hours for balance administration. Short personal appointments may be handled through schedule flexibility with manager approval when no time is missed and work expectations are met.

## 5. Carryover, Expiration, and Maximum Balance

Up to 10 unused PTO days carry from one calendar year to the next. The current rule applies to balances carried into calendar year 2027 and later. The earlier policy allowed only 5 days; that limit is no longer current.

At year-end, the system separates the carried amount from new-year accrual. Carried time above the employee's regular current-year accrual should be used first and expires on March 31 if unused, unless law requires a different result or People Operations approves an extension because BluePeak canceled previously approved leave.

The maximum PTO bank is 25 days. Accrual pauses when the balance reaches 25 days and resumes after approved use brings the balance below the cap. Paused accrual is not restored retroactively. Managers should help employees schedule time before they reach the cap.

### 5.1 No Purchase, Sale, or Donation Program

BluePeak does not offer routine PTO purchase, cash-out, sale, or donation. PTO is paid only through approved use or separation payout. People Operations may establish a temporary emergency leave-sharing program only through a separately approved written notice.

## 6. Unplanned Absence and Other Leave Types

PTO may be requested for an unexpected personal matter, but illness, medical care, or eligible family-care time should normally be recorded under Sick Leave. A manager should not require an employee to use PTO when another protected or company leave applies.

If an absence may qualify for parental, disability, family, military, jury, bereavement, accommodation, or other protected leave, contact People Operations. PTO may run concurrently with an unpaid protected leave when permitted and may be used to replace unpaid time, but the leave designation and protections remain separate.

## 7. Holidays and Office Closures

A company holiday does not reduce the employee's PTO balance. When a holiday occurs during approved PTO, only the scheduled workdays surrounding the holiday are charged. If a site or the company closes unexpectedly, employees should follow the closure notice; PTO will not be charged unless the employee was already scheduled for PTO and the notice states otherwise.

## 8. Cancellation and Changes

Employees should cancel or modify a request promptly when plans change. Managers may cancel approved PTO only for a significant, documented business emergency after consulting People Operations. BluePeak will consider reasonable nonrefundable costs directly caused by a company cancellation, but reimbursement requires receipts and executive approval.

An employee who becomes ill during scheduled PTO may request that eligible days be reclassified as Sick Leave. The employee must notify the manager promptly and follow the Sick Leave Policy.

# 9. Separation, Transfer, and Rehire

Accrued unused PTO is paid at the employee's base rate in the final paycheck. The payout excludes future accrual, expired time, unearned advances, bonuses, commissions, premiums, and allowances. Final-pay timing follows the Payroll Schedule & Direct Deposit Policy and applicable law.

A transfer to Dublin or another location with a different annual-leave structure is reviewed by People Operations to avoid an unintended loss or duplicate benefit. A rehired employee begins a new bank unless a law or written rehire arrangement requires restoration; prior service may count for the tenure band when the break in service is 12 months or less.

# 10. Manager Responsibilities

Managers must maintain appropriate coverage, review requests promptly, apply standards consistently, protect leave information, and avoid asking for unnecessary personal details. Managers should monitor employees approaching the cap and should not create a culture in which employees are discouraged from taking earned time.

Managers must involve People Operations before canceling approved leave, denying a request connected to a protected reason, approving a negative balance, or treating an absence as misconduct when a medical or other protected issue may be involved.

# 11. Employee Frequently Asked Questions

## 11.1 Do I receive all 15 days on January 1?

No. PTO accrues monthly. The annual total describes the full-year amount for an eligible employee who remains in the same status for the year.

## 11.2 Can I use PTO before it appears in my balance?

Only an approved advance may create a negative balance. Do not assume future accrual can be used.

## 11.3 Does an approved request guarantee the dates can never change?

BluePeak treats approval as a commitment. A manager may cancel only for a significant business emergency after People Operations review.

## 11.4 What happens when I reach 25 days?

Accrual pauses. Use approved PTO to bring the balance below 25 days; accrual then resumes prospectively.

## 11.5 Which time is used first after year-end?

Carried time subject to the March 31 expiration is used before regular current-year accrual.

## 11.6 Can my manager require me to check email while on PTO?

No, unless an exceptional, documented on-call arrangement applies. PTO is intended to provide time away from work.

# 90. Administration, Exceptions, and Questions

BluePeak administers Paid Time Off consistently with the employee's work location, employment classification, written employment terms, and applicable law. A statutory or contractual entitlement that is more generous than this document will apply to the extent required. A manager may not waive a legal requirement, create a new benefit, or promise an exception without written approval from the document owner.

Employees should raise questions before relying on an informal interpretation. Contact people@bluepeaktech.com through Outlook or the People Help channel in Microsoft Teams. Payroll, Legal, Information Security, or a site leader will be consulted when the question involves tax, wage-and-hour, privacy, immigration, safety, or local-law considerations.

Approved exceptions must identify the employee, the policy provision, the business reason, the approving authority, the start and end date, and any conditions. Exceptions are stored with the employee or transaction record and do not establish a precedent for other employees.

# 91. Related Documents and Systems

| Resource | When to use it |
|---|---|
| Leave Request Form | Submit PTO dates, coverage information, and approval routing. |
| Sick Leave Policy | Illness, medical care, family care, documentation, and return-to-work rules. |
| Parental Leave Policy | Paid parental leave, notice, benefits, and phased return. |
| Bereavement Leave Policy | Paid bereavement and compassionate leave. |
| Payroll Schedule & Direct Deposit Policy | PTO payout and final-pay timing. |

# Revision History

| Version | Effective date | Change summary |
|---|---|---|
| v3.0 | 2026-07-01 | Consolidated the July 2026 carryover update into the full policy; carryover is 10 days, excess expires March 31, and the maximum balance is 25 days. |